

TWENTY-FOURTH NORTHERN MARIANAS COMMONWEALTH

LEGISLATURE

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

NOVEMBER 6, 2025

SECOND REGULAR SESSION, 2025

C. Res. 24-5

A HOUSE COMMEMORATIVE RESOLUTION

To celebrate and commemorate the Northern Marianas Islands Football Association's (NMIFA) 20th Anniversary and the remarkable impact NMIFA has made in the Commonwealth of the Northern Marianas Islands.

1 **WHEREAS**, the Legislature honors and celebrates those organizations that
2 foster a strong spirit of community, sportsmanship, health, and unity for the people
3 of the Commonwealth of the Northern Marianas Islands (CNMI); and

4 **WHEREAS**, the Northern Marianas Islands Football Association
5 (NMIFA) is a well-deserved testament of such an organization that is deeply rooted
6 in the islands and continues to uplift CNMI community members of all ages; and

7 **WHEREAS**, the Northern Mariana Islands Football Association came from
8 humble beginnings with a story built on the passion and commitment from
9 dedicated individuals behind the NMIFA to provide and nurture a thriving soccer
10 community for our people; and

11 **WHEREAS**, the NMIFA's mission is to foster a positive sports culture and
12 way of life in the Northern Mariana Islands by providing a professionally structured

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1 football organization that welcomes and supports players of all skill levels, age, and
2 genders; and

3 **WHEREAS**, the NMIFA’s vision is to use soccer’s influence in the CNMI
4 to encourage people of all ages to lead healthier lifestyles, ultimately making the
5 Northern Mariana Islands a better place to live, learn, and play. From grassroots
6 programs to elite player development, NMIFA’s approach is not only to enhance
7 players’ talents and skills, but also to deliver valuable life lessons beyond the field,
8 breaking down barriers and inspiring every player to pursue their dreams; and

9 **WHEREAS**, the NMIFA was established in 2005 as a non-profit
10 organization to serve as the sole organizer of soccer in the CNMI. Before the
11 formation of NMIFA, soccer was played loosely by approximately 100 youth and
12 men. In its first season, the NMIFA registered over 250 registrations youth players,
13 and quickly expanded and began its women's and men's leagues. By 2007, the
14 NMIFA became an Associate Member of the East Asian Football Federation
15 (EAFF); and

16 **WHEREAS**, in 2008, the NMIFA received full membership to the EAFF,
17 and continued to widen its reach by starting an Interscholastic Soccer League for
18 elementary students. Every year, the NMIFA sent teams to international EAFF
19 sanctioned competitions. In 2009, the NMIFA became an Associate Member of the
20 Asian Football Confederation (AFC); and

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1 **WHEREAS**, in 2011, the Boys U15 National Team won the CNMI's first
2 national team victory in an international competition at the EAFF U15 Youth
3 Tournament against Macau. The NMIFA's teams continued to hone their skills and
4 participated in multiple AFC and EAFF events. In 2013, the Boys U14 claimed the
5 CNMI's first AFC win. In 2014, the NMI Men's and Women's National Teams
6 recorded double victories against Macau in the EAFF East Asian Cup Preliminary
7 Round; and

8 **WHEREAS**, after years of active participation as an Associate Member,
9 the NMIFA was admitted into the AFC as an Ordinary Member in 2020. The
10 NMIFA continues to work closely with the AFC to develop soccer and involve new
11 segments of players in the CNMI; and

12 **WHEREAS**, in 2018, the NMI Soccer Training Center opened its doors to
13 the community, offering two pitches, spectator seating, evening access, and offices
14 and training rooms. In 2022, an additional full-sized pitch was added to the facility.
15 In 2025, the NMIFA completed additions to the facility, a training room, a changing
16 room, and a conference room; and

17 **WHEREAS**, local referees and coaches were regularly trained to raise the
18 technical skills in the program. The NMIFA provides licensing training for soccer
19 coaches and referees, offering coaches with local clinics, workshops, and
20 educational courses both locally and during international events. To date, the
21 organization has produced 205 licensed coaches; and

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1 **WHEREAS**, the NMIFA conducts multiple referee courses throughout the
2 year focusing on both certification and refresher training to develop and maintain
3 NMIFA’s officiating standards, while providing opportunities for advancement and
4 career development; and

5 **WHEREAS**, the NMIFA has developed skilled players to form the NMI
6 National Teams. The National Teams embody the passion and determination of the
7 islands through rigorous year-round training and competitions. The NMIFA has
8 organized or competed in a total 139 local and international competitions over the
9 course of 20 years; and

10 **WHEREAS**, the National Teams have proudly carried the NMI flag in
11 these competitions held in 23 countries and 44 cities globally, proudly recording a
12 total of 20 wins and 10 draws in competitions for youth and adults; and

13 **WHEREAS**, since 2005, the NMIFA's total registered players have
14 consistently grown. Today, there are over 1,500 registered male and female players
15 ranging from youth to veterans—making soccer the largest organized sport in the
16 CNMI and since the beginning, the NMIFA has remained committed to growing
17 women’s participation by providing equal opportunities in all aspects of the sport;
18 and

19 **WHEREAS**, the NMIFA’s commitment to high standards in youth soccer
20 was reaffirmed through the renewal of its AFC Grassroots Charter Bronze
21 Membership, a prestigious recognition validates NMIFA’s systematic and inclusive

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1 approach to grassroots development and reflects dedication to not only growing in
2 numbers but also in quality, structure, and long-term impact; and

3 **WHEREAS**, in 2025, the NMIFA was recognized for its work in
4 developing its grassroots program by being shortlisted in the prestigious AFC
5 President’s Recognition Award for Grassroots Football in the Bronze Category; and

6 **WHEREAS**, the NMIFA values the importance of social responsibility and
7 contributing positively to the community that has embraced the organization
8 through the years; and

9 **WHEREAS**, the NMIFA has developed a strong partnership with the
10 CNMI Public School System in managing the Interscholastic Soccer League and
11 providing coaching clinics through the Physical Education Support Program,
12 imparting guidance, skills, and a love for soccer to the youth of the CNMI; and

13 **WHEREAS**, every year, the NMIFA also participates in the Marianas
14 March Against Cancer to help in their fundraising efforts, further signaling the
15 organization’s dedication to public service and worthwhile community causes; and

16 **WHEREAS**, the NMIFA’s 20th Year Anniversary in 2025 is a celebration
17 of 20 years of passion, purpose and promise to continue making the Marianas a
18 better place to live, learn, and play; and

19 **WHEREAS**, the NMIFA is a shining example of community values,
20 partnerships, healthy lifestyle, and camaraderie that arises from a love for sports

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1 with future community partnerships, victories, and growth to look forward to in
2 years to come; and

3 **NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED** by the House of
4 Representatives of the Twenty-Fourth Northern Marianas Commonwealth
5 Legislature that the House celebrates and commemorates the Northern Mariana
6 Islands Football Association (NMIFA) on their 20th Anniversary and the
7 remarkable impact NMIFA has made in the Commonwealth of the Northern
8 Mariana Islands; and

9 **BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED** that the Sponsor of this Resolution or the
10 designee of the Speaker of the House shall present a certified original copy of this
11 House Commemorative Resolution; and

12 **BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED** that the Speaker of the House of
13 Representatives shall certify, and the House Clerk shall attest to the adoption of this
14 resolution and thereafter the House Clerk shall transmit a certified copy to the Jerry
15 Tan, President of the Northern Marianas Islands Football Association; the
16 Honorable David M. Apatang, Governor, Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana
17 Islands; the Honorable Kimberlyn K. King-Hinds, CNMI Delegate to the U.S.
18 House of Representatives, 119th United States Congress; the Honorable Karl R.
19 King-Nabors, Senate President, 24th Northern Marianas Commonwealth
20 Legislature; the Honorable Ramon “RB” Jose B. Camacho, Mayor of Saipan; the
21 Honorable Valentino N. Taisacan Jr., Mayor of the Northern Islands; the Honorable

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- 1 Edwin P. Aldan, Mayor of Tinian and Aguiguan; and the Honorable Aubry M.
- 2 Hocog, Mayor of Rota.

Prefiled: 11/5/2025

Date: _____ Introduced by: /s/ Rep. Edmund S. Villagomez

/s/ Rep. Roy C.A. Ada

/s/ Rep. Vincent R. Aldan

/s/ Rep. Daniel I. Aquino Jr.

/s/ Rep. Blas Jonathan "BJ" T. Attao

/s/ Rep. Roman C. Benavente

/s/ Rep. Angelo A. Camacho

/s/ Rep. Diego V. F. Camacho

/s/ Rep. Joel C. Camacho

/s/ Rep. Joseph A. Flores

/s/ Rep. Marissa R. Flores

/s/ Rep. Thomas J. DLC. Manglona

/s/ Rep. Julie M. A. Ogo

/s/ Rep. Malcolm J. Omar

/s/ Rep. Raymond U. Palacios

/s/ Rep. Elias J.M. Rangamar

/s/ Rep. John Paul P. Sablan

/s/ Rep. Patrick H. San Nicolas

/s/ Rep. Denita Kaipat Yangetmai

/s/ Rep. Ralph N. Yumul